

LESSON 19

Doctrine, Reproof, Correction, Training—What It All Means

8: Studying the Bible

Executive Summary

Paul tells Timothy that all Scripture is profitable for four specific purposes: doctrine (teaches the path God designs), reproof (reveals when we've stepped off the path), correction (guides us back to the right path), and training in righteousness (keeps us walking on the path). This four-fold pattern is the framework for a lifetime of Bible study.

Key Terms

Doctrine	Biblical truth organized and clearly stated so that believers know what to believe and how to live.
Reproof	Scripture's work of exposing error and showing where belief or behavior has departed from God's path.
Correction	Scripture's work of restoring wrong belief or conduct to the path God has revealed.
Righteousness	Conformity to God's holy character and standard, received in Christ and increasingly practiced by believers.

Key Verses

English Standard Version (ESV)

2 Timothy 3:16-17

16 All Scripture is breathed out by God and profitable for teaching, for reproof, for correction, and for training in righteousness, 17 that the man of God may be complete, equipped for every good work.

James 1:22

22 But be doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving yourselves.

Application Questions

1. Read 2 Timothy 3:16-17 and James 1:22. What belief, attitude, or action do these verses call you to embrace?

2. Which key term most clarifies your understanding of Scripture's fourfold purpose, and why?

3. Where does the truth about Scripture's fourfold purpose confront a current assumption, habit, fear, temptation, or responsibility in your life?

4. What specific step of faith or obedience will you take this week, and who can help you follow through?
